Grayson Iller

UX Engineer

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SUMMARY

UX Engineer with 3+ years on connected hardware at Skydio, leading controller validation from first bring-up through GA across multiple hardware generations. I also designed and shipped VUE, a production React and TypeScript product built solo. Background in human factors psychology.

EXPERIENCE

Skydio | Flight Test Engineer Lead, Device Platform | San Mateo, CA | June 2023 to Present

- Own controller validation across multiple concurrent programs, including next-generation enterprise controller bring-up, unified production releases, and a first-ever controller-only software release.
- Test lead for the next-generation enterprise controller from early bring-up through Alpha and Beta, identifying integration gaps across controller, mobile, and vehicle systems.
- Modeled controller-to-drone connectivity as a state machine to find states where the UI reported normal operation while the link was degraded, then worked with engineering on how the UI should represent them.
- Validated multi-system interactions across the full stack (mobile app, controller, vehicle, radio and LTE connectivity), including connectivity transitions, telemetry behavior, media access, and off-nominal scenarios.
- Contributed to hardware reliability validation that reduced controller RMA rate to less than 1%, focused on RF performance and edge-case behavior during manufacturing rollout.
- Bridged UX and system-level testing by evaluating real operator workflows and usability under pressure, with a focus on clarity, predictability, and real-world use in public safety and defense.
- Authored over 5,500 test cases in TestRail across the S2, X2, and X10 Enterprise platforms, and restructured coverage from subsystem modules into operator journeys so gaps between steps became visible.
- Manage a direct report who owns mobile device platform validation; absorbed a second validation program for national security customers when its lead left.

Skydio | Flight Test Intern, UI/Human Factors | May 2022 to August 2022

- Mobile-side flight test: UI/UX feature testing and drone system validation with hardware and software teams, using TestRail, Jira, Instabug, and Figma.

PROJECTS

VUE (vueniverse.com) | Founder, Designer, Engineer | 2024 to Present

- Fashion intelligence platform that aggregates daily new arrivals from 100+ women's fashion brands into one personalized feed. Live in production with real users and affiliate monetization.
- Solo-built full-stack app: dual web-scraping pipeline (Deno + Playwright and Supabase Edge Functions), user auth, brand following, responsive design. React 18, TypeScript, Vite, Supabase, Vercel.
- Designed end to end in Figma and FigJam first, then developed with AI-assisted coding workflows using Claude.
- Ran a design audit that collapsed three auth screens and six button styles into one system: one accent, one type scale, 44px minimum touch targets, WCAG 2.1 AA contrast.

SKILLS

Front End: React 18, TypeScript, JavaScript, Next.js, Vite, Tailwind, Radix, HTML, CSS

Devices and Systems: Hardware bring-up, connectivity (radio, LTE), telemetry, state modeling, release validation, reliability

Prototyping and Design: Figma, FigJam, prototyping, design systems, interaction design, accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA)

AI-Assisted Development: Rapid prototyping and shipping production software using Claude

Tools: Jira, TestRail, Instabug, Supabase, Vercel, Git/GitHub, Linux CLI

EDUCATION

Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University | B.S. Human Factors Psychology (HCI focus), Minor in Aerospace Physiology | 2019 to 2023

NCAA Division II Women's Cross Country and Track & Field. FAA-certified UAV pilot. PADI Open Water Diver. Olympic-distance triathlon finisher.

PUBLICATIONS

- Tooker, M., Iller, G., French, J., McGrath, B., & Rupert, A. (2022). Pilot-in-the-loop technology for moon landings. IAF/IAA Space Life Sciences Symposium.
- Crichton, C., Delgado, L., Iller, G., et al. (2021). The Link Between Spatial Disorientation in Flight and Mild Hypoxia. Reno Aerospace Medicine Convention.